

Importance Sampling (Reweighting)

Reject, Reweight, Repeat "

> Goals: Find the integral

$$1) A = \int a(\theta) f(\theta) d\theta / \int f(\theta) d\theta$$

$$= E(a(\theta)), \text{ where } \theta \sim$$

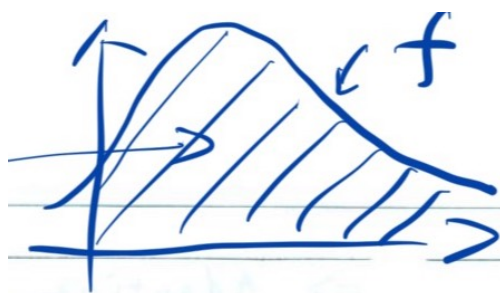
where, $f(\theta)$ is unnormalized

$$f(\theta) = \pi(\theta) p(x|\theta)$$

$$\frac{f(\theta)}{\int f(\theta) d\theta}$$

$\uparrow$
 C_f

$$2) C_f = \int f(\theta) d\theta$$



We can't draw $\theta \sim f(x)$

instead, we can draw $\theta \sim q(\theta)$

where, $q(\theta)$ is another unnormalized

function, we hope $\frac{f(\theta)}{q(\theta)} \approx a$ (constant)

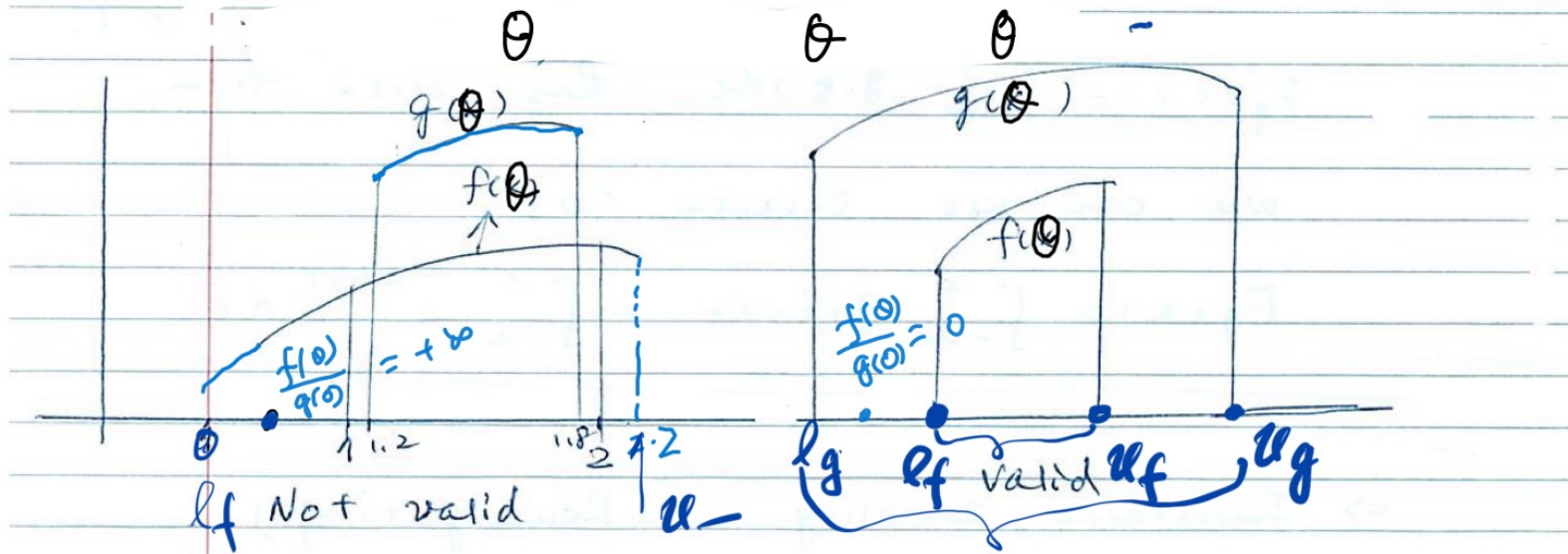
Requirement for $q(\theta)$:

$$\{\theta | q(\theta) > 0\} \supseteq \{\theta | f(\theta) > 0\}$$

Example of Supports of g and f

$$(l_f, u_f) \supseteq (l_g, u_g)$$

$$(l_f, u_f) \supseteq (l_g, u_g)$$



Importance Reweighting Formula

1) draw $\theta_1, \dots, \theta_n \sim g$

2) $\frac{C_f}{C_g} : \frac{\sum_{i=1}^n \frac{f(\theta_i)}{g(\theta_i)}}{n}$, where $w(\theta) = \frac{f(\theta)}{g(\theta)}$

$$= \frac{\sum_{i=1}^n w(\theta_i)}{n}$$

$$\hat{A} = \frac{\sum_{i=1}^n a(\theta_i) \frac{f(\theta_i)}{g(\theta_i)}}{\sum_{i=1}^n w(\theta_i)} = \frac{\left[\sum_{i=1}^n a(\theta_i) w(\theta_i) \right] / n}{\left[\sum_{i=1}^n w(\theta_i) \right] / n}$$

where, $w(\theta_i) = \frac{f(\theta_i)}{g(\theta_i)}$

$$\hat{A} = \sum_{i=1}^n a(\theta_i) \cdot \tilde{w}(\theta_i)$$

$$\tilde{w}(\theta_i) = \frac{w(\theta_i)}{\sum_{i=1}^n w(\theta_i)}$$

$$\sum_{i=1}^n \tilde{w}(\theta_i) = 1$$

e.g.

	θ_1	θ_2	θ_3
$w(\theta)$	100	40	60
$\tilde{w}(\theta)$	0.5	0.2	0.3

Derivation of Importance Reweighting Formula

$$\begin{aligned} E_f(a(\theta)) &= \int_{l_f}^{u_f} a(\theta) \frac{f(\theta)}{C_f} d\theta = \frac{1}{C_f} \int_{l_f}^{u_f} a(\theta) f(\theta) d\theta \\ &= \frac{C_g}{C_f} \int_{l_f}^{u_f} \left(a(\theta) \frac{f(\theta)}{g(\theta)} \right) \cdot \frac{g(\theta)}{C_g} d\theta = \frac{C_g}{C_f} \int_{l_g}^{u_g} a(\theta) \frac{f(\theta)}{g(\theta)} \frac{g(\theta)}{C_g} d\theta \end{aligned}$$

↑

requiring $\{0 < g(\theta) < \infty\} \supseteq \{0 < f(\theta) < \infty\}$

$$\begin{aligned} &= E_g \left(a(\theta) \cdot \frac{f(\theta)}{g(\theta)} \right) / \left(\frac{C_f}{C_g} \right) \\ &= E_g \left(a(\theta) \cdot \frac{f(\theta)}{g(\theta)} \right) / \frac{C_f}{C_g} \end{aligned}$$

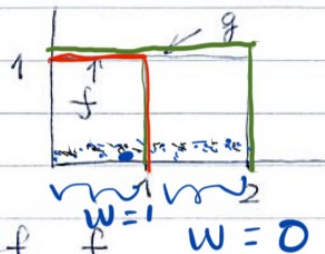
$W(\theta) = \frac{f(\theta)}{g(\theta)}$ is called importance weight.

$$\frac{C_f}{C_g} = \int \frac{f(\theta)}{g(\theta)} \cdot \frac{g(\theta)}{C_g} d\theta = \frac{\int f(\theta) d\theta}{\int g(\theta) d\theta}$$

$$= E_g \left(\frac{f(\theta)}{g(\theta)} \right)$$

example 1) $f(\theta) = I(0 \leq \theta \leq 1)$

$g(\theta) = I(0 \leq \theta \leq 2)$



$C_f = 1$

$C_g = 2$

Support of $g \supset$ support of f $w=0$

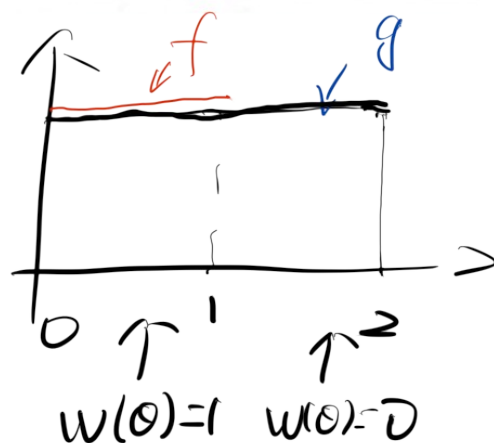
We want to estimate $\frac{C_f}{C_g}$ (true = $\frac{1}{2}$)

Suppose $\theta_s \sim g[\text{unif}([0, 2])]$

$$W(\theta_s) = \frac{f(\theta_s)}{g(\theta_s)} = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } 0 \leq \theta_s \leq 1 \\ 0 & \text{if } 1 < \theta_s \leq 2 \end{cases}$$

$$\left(\frac{C_f}{C_g} \right) = \frac{\sum_{s=1}^S W(\theta_s)}{S} \approx \frac{1}{2}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \hat{A} &= \frac{\sum_s a(\theta_s) W(\theta_s)}{\sum_s W(\theta_s)} \\ &= \frac{\sum_{0 < \theta_s < 1} a(\theta_s)}{\sum_s I(0 < \theta_s < 1)} \end{aligned}$$



$$= \frac{1}{n_E} \sum_{0 < \theta_s < 1} a(\theta_s), \text{ where } n_E = \#(0 < \theta_s < 1) \approx \frac{1}{2} S$$

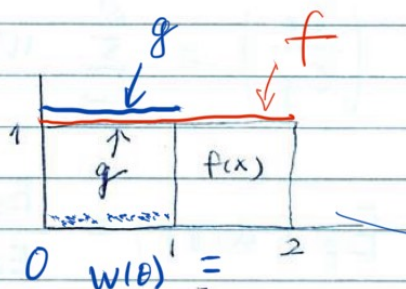
example 2) $f(\theta) = I(0 \leq \theta \leq 2)$

$g(\theta) = I(0 \leq \theta \leq 1)$

support of $g \subset$ support of f

We want to estimate

$$\frac{C_f}{C_g} \quad (\text{true} \leq 2)$$



suppose $\theta_s \sim g \text{ [unif}([0, 1])\text{]}$

$$W(\theta_s) = \frac{f(\theta_s)}{g(\theta_s)} = 1$$

$$\left(\frac{C_f}{C_g} \right) = \frac{\sum_{s=1}^S W(\theta_s)}{S} = 1 \neq 2 \quad (\text{true value})$$

Example of Poor Importance Sampling



Effective sample size:

$$S_{\text{eff}} = \frac{1}{\sum_{s=1}^S \tilde{W}^2(\theta_s)}$$

$$\text{where, } \tilde{W}(\theta_s) = \frac{W(\theta_s)}{\sum_{s=1}^S W(\theta_s)}$$

(Not reliable)

A special case $\tilde{W}(\theta_s) = \frac{c}{S \cdot c}$

If $W(\theta_s) \approx c$, then, $\tilde{W}(\theta_s) = \frac{1}{S}$

$$\text{then, } S_{\text{eff}} = \frac{1}{\sum_{s=1}^S \left(\frac{1}{S}\right)^2} = \frac{1}{\frac{1}{S}} = S$$

$$\text{Var}_f \left(\frac{\sum_{s=1}^S a(\theta_s)}{S} \right) = \frac{\text{Var}_f(a(\theta_s))}{S}$$

$$\text{Var}_g \left(\frac{\sum_{s=1}^S a(\theta_s) W(\theta_s)}{\sum_{s=1}^S W(\theta_s)} \right) \approx \frac{\text{Var}(a(\theta_s))}{S_{\text{eff}}}$$

But S_{eff} is not reliable

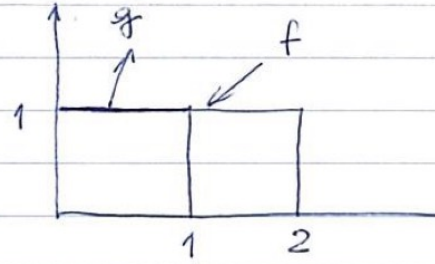
example 3):

$$f(\theta) = I(0 \leq \theta \leq 2)$$

$$g(\theta) = I(0 \leq \theta \leq 1)$$

$$\text{all } \theta_s \sim \text{unif}([0, 1])$$

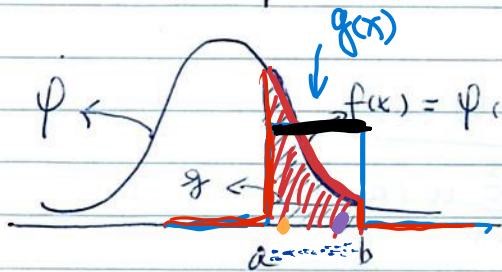
$$W(\theta_s) = 1 \quad S_{\text{eff}} = S$$



example 4. Estimate integral

$$\int_a^b \varphi(x) dx = I$$

where $\varphi = \text{dnorm}(x)$, $X \sim N(0,1)$



$$A = \int_a^b a(x) \cdot \frac{\varphi(x)}{I} dx$$

$$f(x) = \varphi(x) \cdot I(a \leq x \leq b) = E f(a(x))$$

$$c_f = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} f(x) dx = P(a < X < b)$$

Option 1:

$$g(x) = I(a \leq x \leq b), \quad C_g = b - a$$

Suppose we have $X_s \sim g(\text{unif}([a, b]))$

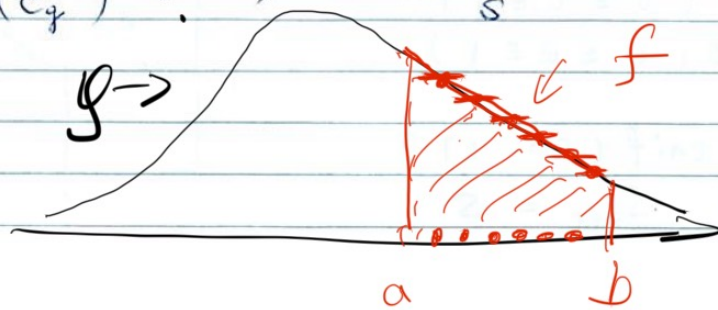
$$W(X_s) = \frac{f(X_s)}{g(X_s)} = \psi(X_s)$$

$$\left(\frac{C_f}{C_g} \right) = \frac{\sum_{s=1}^S W(X_s)}{S} = \frac{\sum_{s=1}^S \psi(X_s)}{S}$$

$$\hat{A} = \frac{\sum_{s=1}^S a(X_s) \psi(X_s)}{\sum_{s=1}^S \psi(X_s)}$$

we know $C_g = b - a$

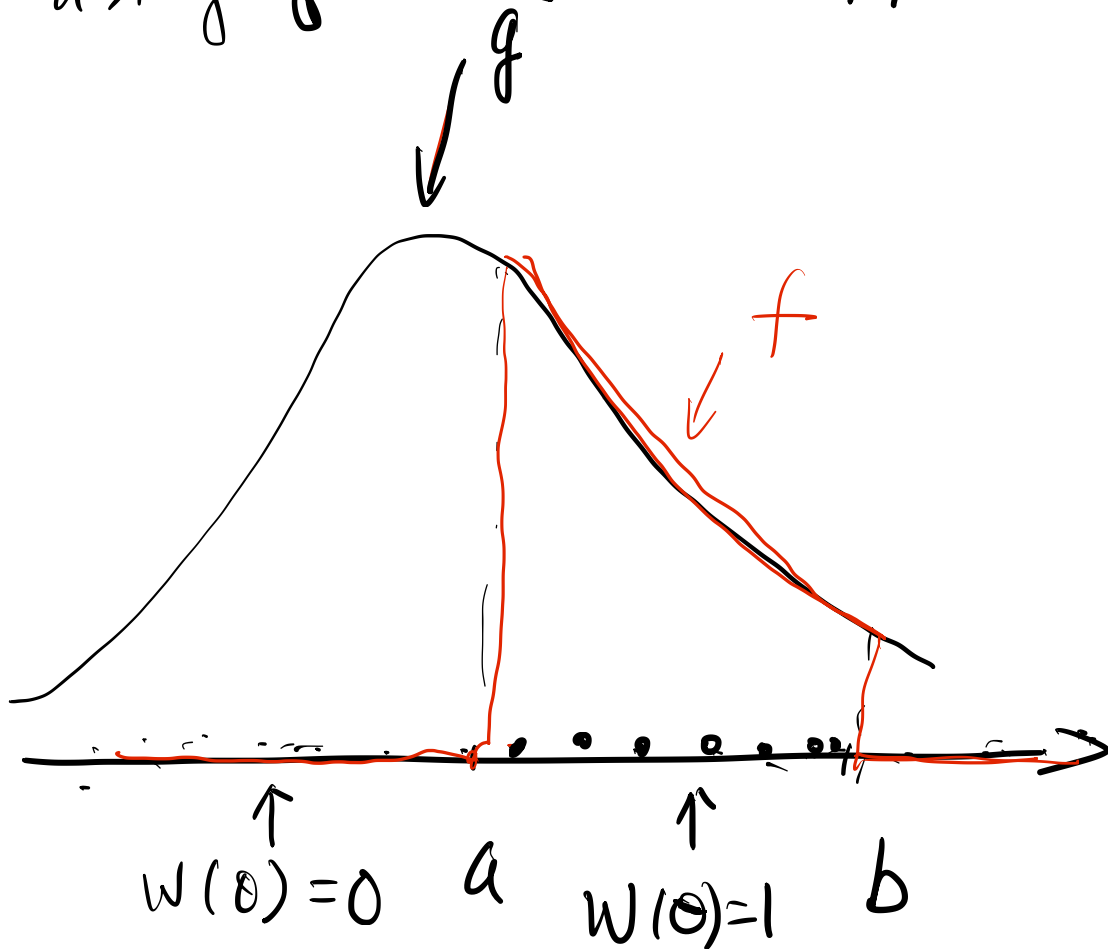
$$\hat{C}_f = \left(\frac{\hat{C}_f}{C_g} \right) \cdot (b - a) = \frac{\sum_{s=1}^S \psi(X_s)}{S} \cdot (b - a) = \sum_{s=1}^S \psi(X_s) \cdot \frac{b - a}{S}$$



randomized
midpoint
rule

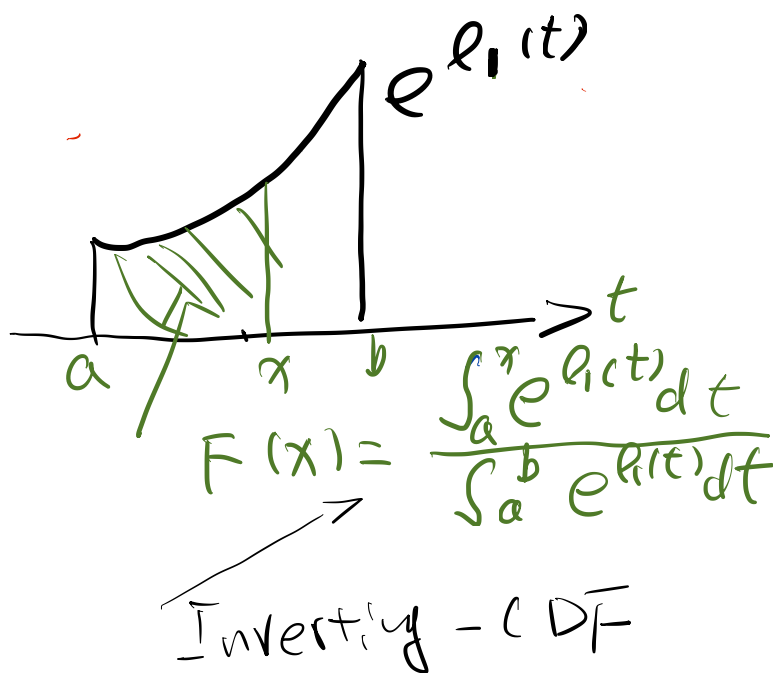
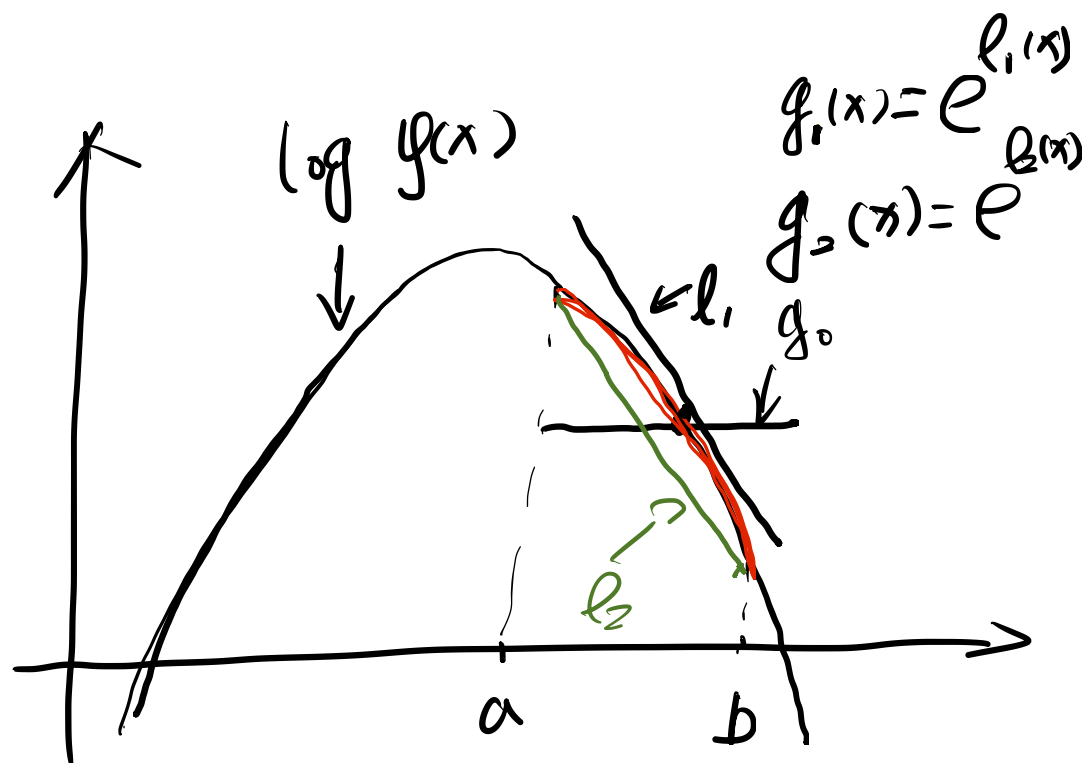
Option 2:

using $g(x) = \varphi(x)$ to approx. f

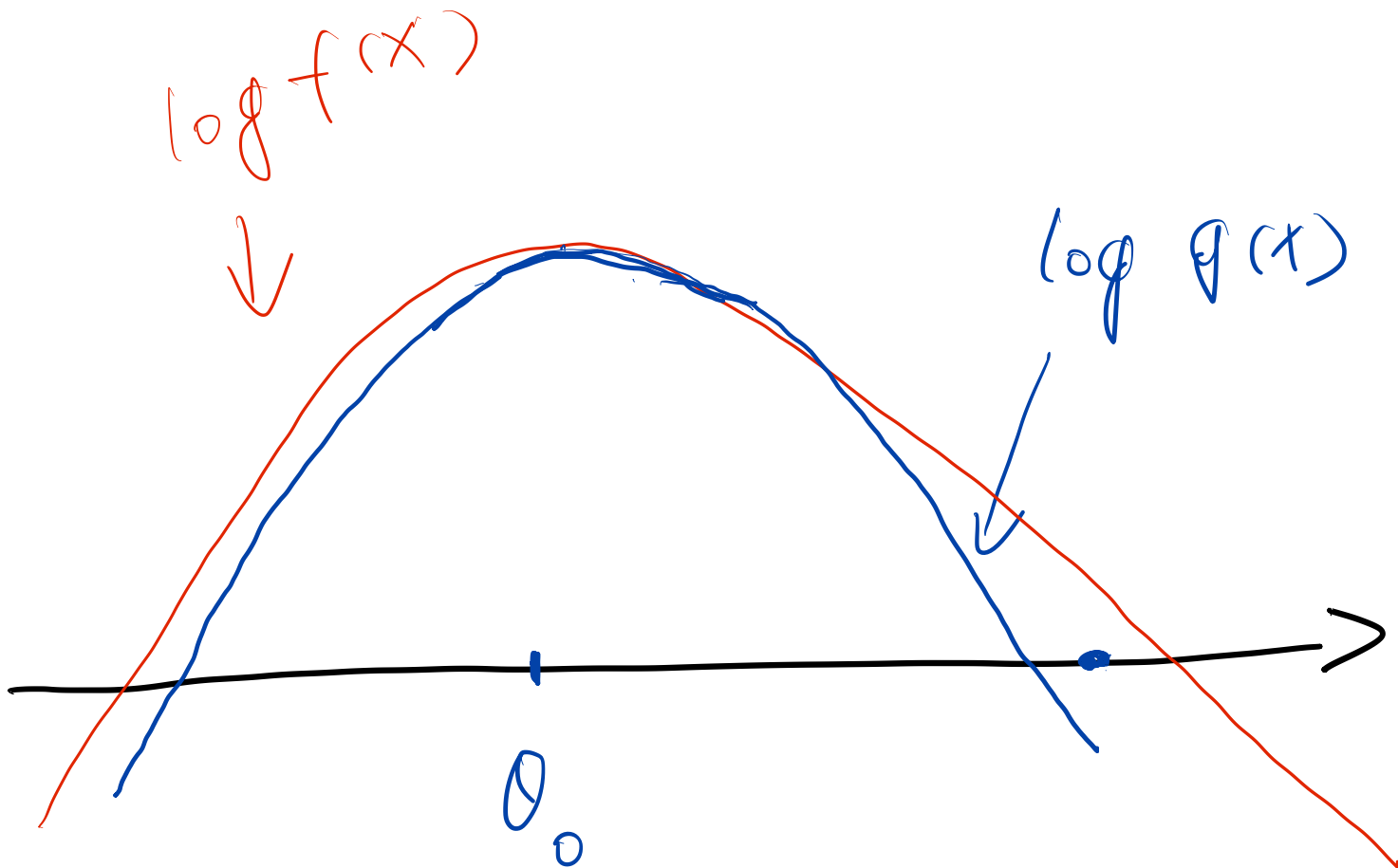


$$\begin{aligned} \left(\frac{C_f}{C_g} \right) &= \frac{\sum w(\theta_i)}{n} \\ &= \frac{\#(a < \theta_i < b)}{n} \end{aligned}$$

More choices of $g(x)$

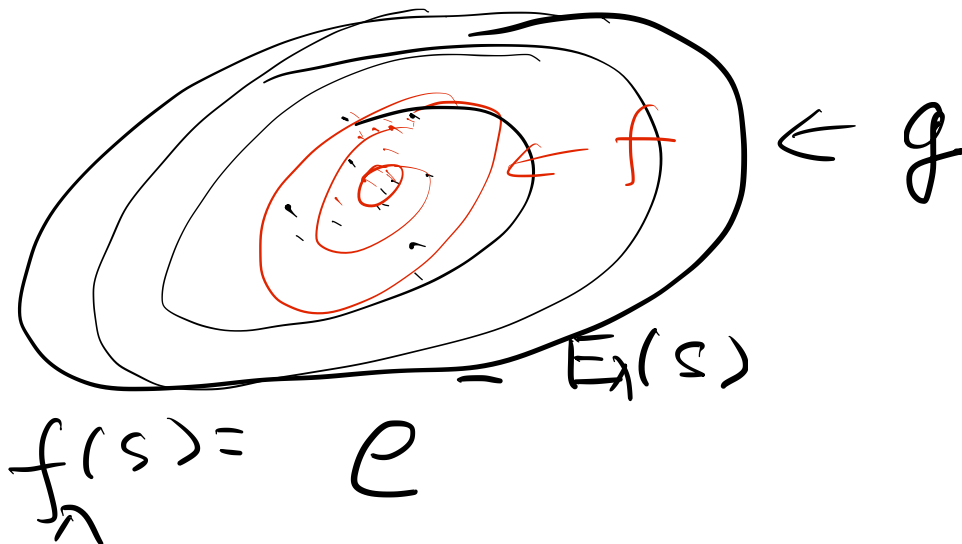


Example: using quadratic functions
to approximate $\log f(x)$.



Advanced Examples

- Free energy

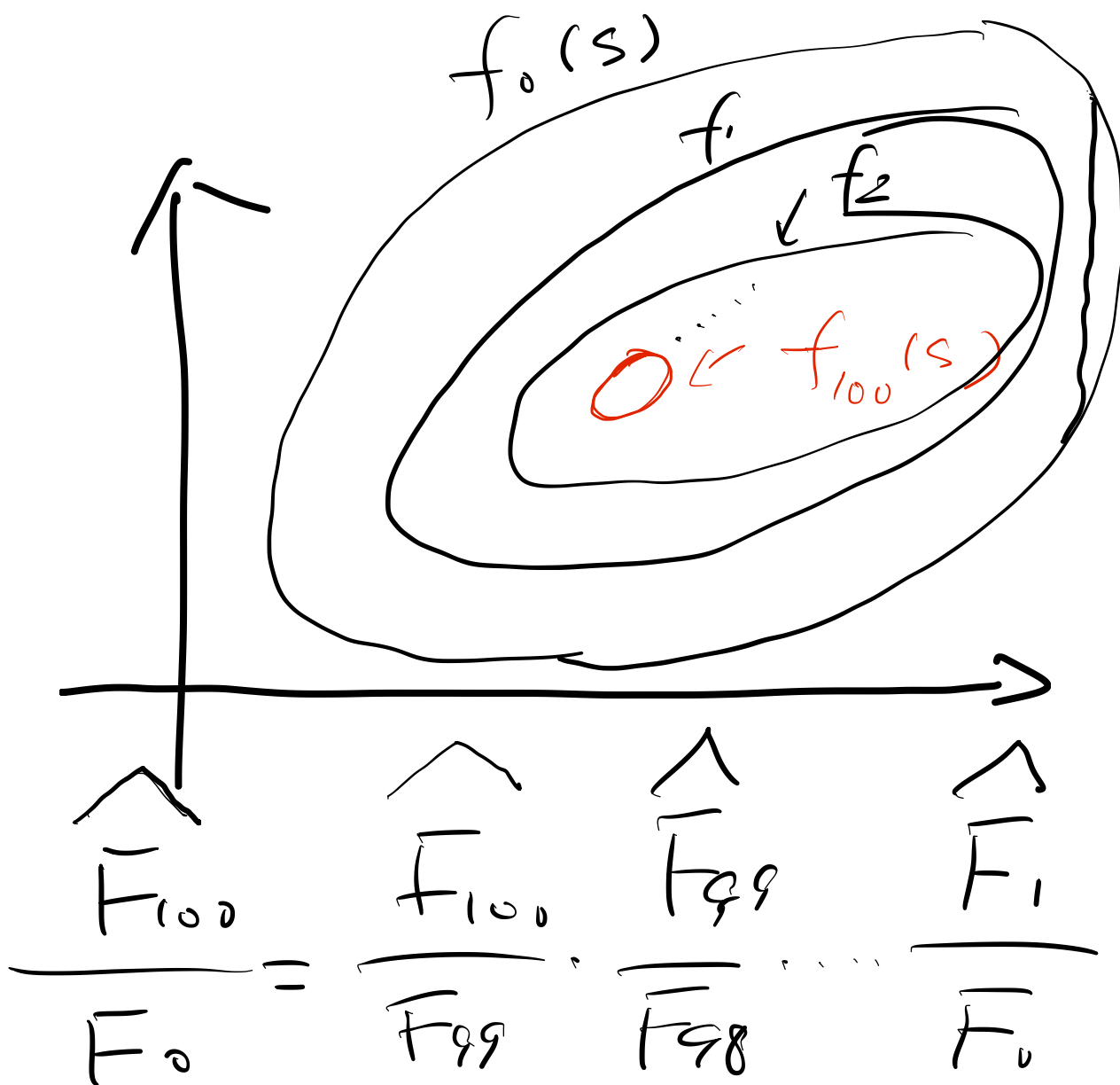


$$\bar{F}(\lambda) = \int f_\lambda(s) ds - \bar{E}_0(s)$$

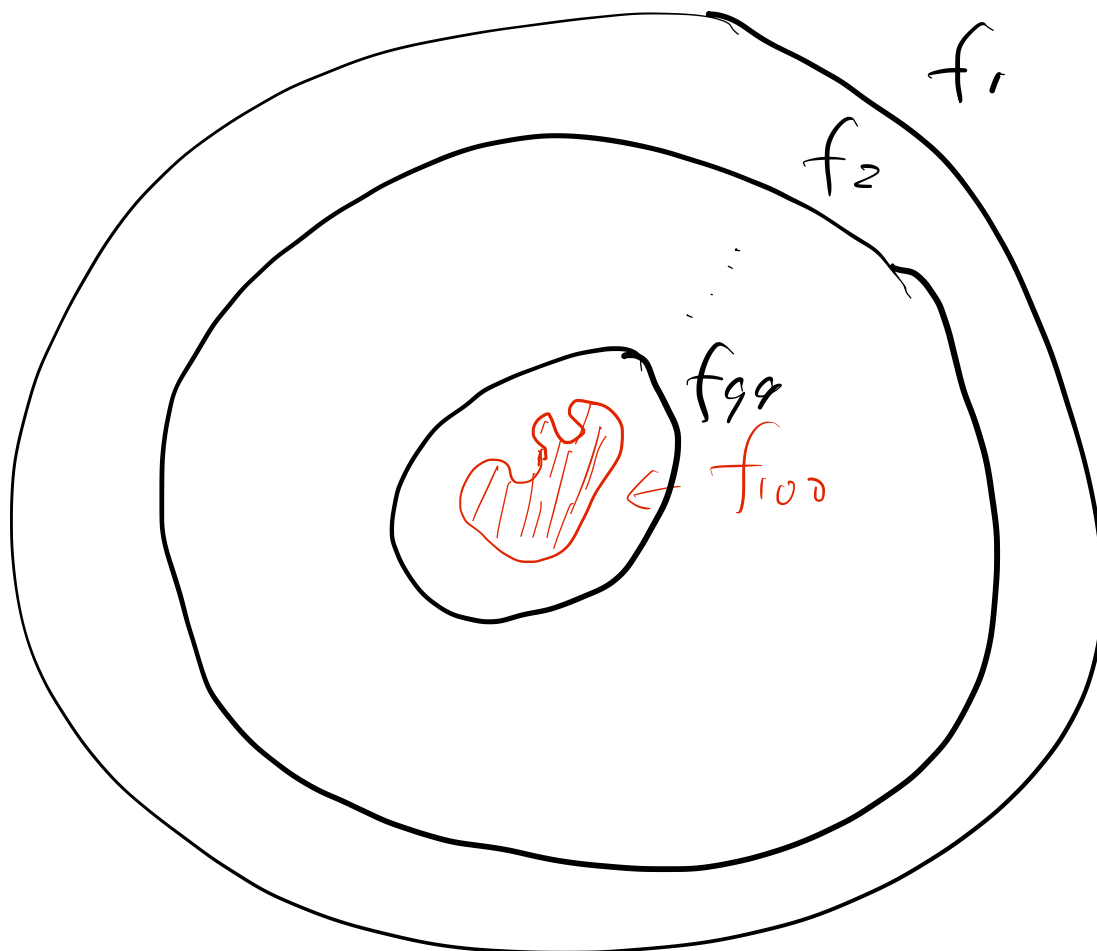
$$f_0(s) = g(s) = e$$

$$\frac{\bar{F}(\lambda)}{\bar{F}(0)} = \sum_s \frac{f_\lambda(s)}{f_0(s)} / n$$

with $s \sim f_0(s) = g(s)$



A Toy Example: Estimating the Area of the Red Area



Approximating Cross-validation

$$y_1, \dots, \boxed{y_i}, \dots, y_n$$

$$f(\theta | y_1, \dots, y_n) \\ \propto f(\theta) = \prod_{i=1}^n p(y_i | \theta) \cdot \pi(\theta)$$

Full data posterior

$$f_{-i}(\theta | y_1, \dots, y_{i-1}, y_{i+1}, \dots, y_n)$$

$$\propto f(\theta) = \prod_{j \neq i} p(y_j | \theta) \cdot \pi(\theta)$$

$$w(\theta) = \frac{f(\theta)}{g(\theta)} = \frac{1}{p(y_i | \theta)}$$